

Geographical enquiry

117

KNOWLEDGE FOCUS

You will answer questions on:

- 11.1 Understanding the route to geographical enquiry and planning fieldwork
- 11.2 Data collection methods, fieldwork safety and equipment
- 11.3 Presenting and analysing data
- 11.4 Making conclusions

EXAM SKILLS FOCUS

In this topic you will:

- show that you understand the command word 'devise' and answer a 'devise' question
- show that you understand the command word 'estimate' and answer an 'estimate' question
- show that you understand the command word 'suggest' and answer a 'suggest' question.

The route to geographical enquiry is assessed through Component 3, Coursework or Paper 4, Geographical Investigations. Both options have an emphasis on testing Assessment Objective 2 Skills and analysis, but also have elements of Assessment Objective 1 Knowledge and understanding, and Assessment Objective 3 Evaluation and decision-making. Paper 4 contains two compulsory questions, each of which are worth 30 marks. The questions can relate to topics covered in Paper 1 or 2.

The command word 'devise' means to create a questionnaire to present other information according to specific requirements. When answering 'devise' questions, make sure that your questionnaire is clear and meets the requirements of the question.

The command word 'estimate' means to use judgement to give a unit value to a distance or area. When answering 'estimate' questions, it is important to use any scales, measurements or references that are provided.

'Suggest' means to apply knowledge and understanding to situations where there are a range of valid responses in order to make proposals/put forward considerations. Unlike questions with fixed answers, 'suggest' questions test your ability to think logically, make predictions and consider different geographical factors. You practised 'suggest' questions in [Topic 4](#) – this unit offers another chance to apply your understanding of this command word, but to enquiry-based questions.